

WRONG DIRECTION MOVEMENTS

Revision Guide | GERT8000-TW7 | Module 4

Mnemonic: FEW AS GOOD GTP

1. What is a Wrong Direction Movement?

A wrong direction movement (WDM) is any movement of a train over a section of line in the direction opposite to the normal direction of travel for that line.

A WDM for which no signal or signalled route is provided can only be made in specific authorised circumstances — these are listed in GERT8000-TW7 §1.1.

You MUST NOT make any movement in the wrong direction without permission. (TW7)

2. When a Wrong Direction Movement Can Be Made

There are 12 authorised scenarios. Use the mnemonic FEW AS GOOD GTP to remember them all.

F E W A S G O O D G T P

Letter	Scenario	Detail (GERT8000-TW7 §1.1)
F	Failed train	A train cannot continue forward and has to return because it has failed, or it cannot be driven from the cab at the leading end.
E	Engineering train	An engineering train is to move towards or from a line under possession.
W	Wrong route	A train is to return after taking a wrong route at a junction.
A	Assist	A light locomotive or multiple-unit train (loaded or empty) is to proceed over the affected or unaffected line to assist a failed train.
S	Single Line Working	Single line working is in operation.
G	Ground Frame	A shunting movement is to be made through points that are worked from a ground frame.
O	Overrun	A train is to return after overrunning a platform, as long as the overrun is not more than 400 metres (440 yards) beyond the platform.
O	Obstruction	A train is to make a movement to return from or proceed towards a line blocked by an accident, failure, obstruction, or other exceptional incident.
D	Divided train	The front portion of a divided train is to return to the rear portion.

G	Grinder train	A rail-grinding train is to return to extinguish a lineside fire.
T	Track machine	An on-track machine working in section is to return to or towards the published start mileage of the site of work.
P	Protected zone	An engineering train or on-track machine is working in a protection zone.

3. Getting Authority Before the Movement

Before making a wrong direction movement, you must get the authority of: (TW7 §1.2)

- the signaller, or
- the pilot or handsignaller acting on the signaller's instructions.

You must also make sure you understand how far the movement is to proceed.

If the destination might be difficult to identify (e.g. not up to a signal), agree with the signaller to proceed as far as an easily identifiable location — a station, level crossing, tunnel or junction. When you reach that location, speak to the signaller again for further instructions. (TW7 §1.2)

On-track machine working in section (TW7 §1.2 & §2.4)

When an on-track machine may need to return to or towards the published start mileage of the site of work, you can agree with the signaller before the start of work that these movements can be made. A WDM can then be made at any time the supervisor or person in charge tells you it is necessary.

Engineering train or on-track machine in a protection zone (TW7 §1.2)

When working in a protection zone and needing to return towards the limit of the zone, the engineering supervisor (ES) or safe work leader (SWL) can agree with the signaller — before work starts — that these movements will be made. A WDM can then be made at any time the ES or SWL tells you it is necessary.

4. Driving the Train

If authorised to make a WDM: (TW7 §1.2)

- You must drive from the cab at the leading end of the movement, if there is one.
- If there is no cab at the leading end, you may drive from another cab — but only if a competent person is available to control the movement.

Train lights (EMR / PPT)

Movement distance	Action on train lights
Less than 400 metres (440 yards)	No change required
More than 400 metres (440 yards)	Tail lamps at the rear of the movement; marker lights and headlight at the front.

Warning horn

Remember to respond to any whistle board encountered on the opposite track during the movement. (PPT)

5. During the Movement

Speed (TW7 §4.3)

Except during single line working, you must always be able to stop within the distance you can see to be clear.

AWS indications (TW7 §4.4)

You must disregard the AWS indication and cancel any warning indication received during the movement.

Cancel warnings to avoid the brakes applying automatically — then disregard them. (TW7 §4.4)

Points and crossings (TW7 §4.1)

Unless given specific instructions by the pilot during single line working:

- Approach at caution any points, switch diamonds or swing-nose crossings — make sure, if possible, that they are in the correct position.
- Do not pass over any of these at more than 15 mph (25 km/h).
- Do not pass over any unworked points unless: the signaller has confirmed they are secured, or (during SLW) a green handsignal is shown next to the points.

No signal provided (TW7)

When no signal is provided for a wrong direction movement, the security of the signalling system is NOT available. You must:

- Reach a clear understanding before any movement is made.
- Throughout the WDM, carry out only the instructions given.

Level crossings (TW7 §4.2)

Actions vary by crossing type. The table below summarises the requirements for each type.

Crossing type	Driver action for wrong-direction movement (TW7 §4.2)
AHBC (Automatic Half-Barrier)	If told the crossing is locally operated: approach at caution; do not pass unless authorised by a green handsignal at the crossing.
ABCL / AOCL (Locally Monitored)	Stop before the crossing. If emergency plunger provided, use it. Then pass only if safe to do so — sound the horn continuously until the front of the train is on the crossing.
CCTV / OD / RC (a) No attendant	Stop opposite the signal on the other line and get further instructions from the signaller. (During SLW, the pilot will authorise movement at caution.)
CCTV / OD / RC (b) Attendant present	Approach at caution; pass only when authorised by a green handsignal.
Manually controlled	Approach at caution; do not pass until sure it is safe to do so.

crossing	
Red/Green warning lights	Approach at caution; stop short of the crossing; sound a short blast of the horn; pass only if safe to do so.
Barrow or foot crossing (white-light indications)	If told indications will not operate normally: approach at caution; check it is safe before passing over.
Wrong-direction speed restriction board	Comply with the speed shown from the board to the crossing. Can accelerate once the front of the train is on the crossing.

6. What the Signaller Tells the Driver (TW7 §3)

Before the wrong direction movement begins, the signaller must tell you:

- What is required.
- How far the movement can go.
- To check, where possible, that points and crossings are set correctly for the movement.
- That any unworked points have been secured.
- To proceed at caution.
- The arrangements at level crossings.

I *If the destination could be difficult to identify, the signaller must agree with the driver to proceed as far as an identifiable location, then make contact again. (TW7 §3)*

7. Questions & Answers

All answers are sourced from GERT8000-TW7 or the EMR PPT unless stated.

Q: What is the mnemonic used to remember all 12 authorised wrong direction movement scenarios?

A: FEW AS GOOD GTP — Failed train, Engineering train, Wrong route, Assist, Single line working, Ground frame, Overrun, Obstruction, Divided train, Grinder train, Track machine, Protected zone.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.1

Q: Before making a wrong direction movement, whose authority must you obtain?

A: The signaller, or the pilot or handsignaller acting on the signaller's instructions.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.2

Q: What must you be sure of before starting a wrong direction movement?

A: You must make sure you understand how far the movement is to proceed. If the destination might be difficult to identify, agree with the signaller to proceed as far as an easily identifiable location (station, level crossing, tunnel or junction), then contact the signaller again when you reach it.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.2

Q: A wrong direction movement is more than 400 metres. What must you do with the train lights?

A: Place tail lamps at the rear of the movement and set marker lights and headlight at the front of the movement.

GERT8000-TW7 / EMR PPT

Q: What is the maximum speed when passing over points, switch diamonds or swing-nose crossings during a wrong direction movement?

A: 15 mph (25 km/h). You must also approach at caution and make sure, if possible, that they are in the correct position.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.1

Q: What must you do with AWS warnings received during a wrong direction movement?

A: Cancel any warning indication to avoid the brakes applying, then disregard the indication.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.4

Q: A wrong direction movement is required after an overrun. What restriction applies?

A: The overrun must be not more than 400 metres (440 yards) beyond the platform.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.1

Q: During a wrong direction movement approaching an ABCL with no wrong-direction controls, what must you do?

A: Stop before reaching the crossing. If an emergency plunger is provided, use it. Then pass over only if safe to do so — sound the horn continuously until the front of the train is on the crossing.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.2

Q: You are making a wrong direction movement and approach an AHBC. The signaller has told you it is locally operated. What do you do?

A: Approach the crossing at caution and do not pass over it unless authorised by a green handsignal shown at the crossing.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.2

Q: During a wrong direction movement, there is no cab at the leading end. Can you still proceed?

A: Yes — you may drive from another cab, but only if a competent person is available to control the movement.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.2

Q: Name the six things the signaller must tell the driver before a wrong direction movement begins.

A: What is required; how far the movement can go; to check (where possible) that points and crossings are set correctly; that any unworked points have been secured; to proceed at caution; the arrangements at level crossings.

GERT8000-TW7 §3

Q: When no signal is provided for a wrong direction movement, what two things must the driver do?

A: (1) Reach a clear understanding before any movement is made. (2) Throughout the movement, carry out only the instructions given.

GERT8000-TW7

Q: An on-track machine driver wishes to make wrong direction movements back to the start mileage. When can this be pre-agreed?

A: Before the start of work — the driver and signaller agree how far the movements can go, any instructions the driver must carry out, and that the supervisor or person in charge can authorise each movement. A WDM can then be made whenever the supervisor says it is necessary.

GERT8000-TW7 §1.2 & §2.4

Q: What is the speed rule for wrong direction movements (except during single line working)?

A: You must always be able to stop within the distance you can see to be clear.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.3

Q: You approach a crossing with red and green warning lights during a wrong direction movement. What must you do?

A: Approach at caution; stop short of the crossing; sound a short blast of the horn as a warning; pass over only if it is safe to do so.

GERT8000-TW7 §4.2